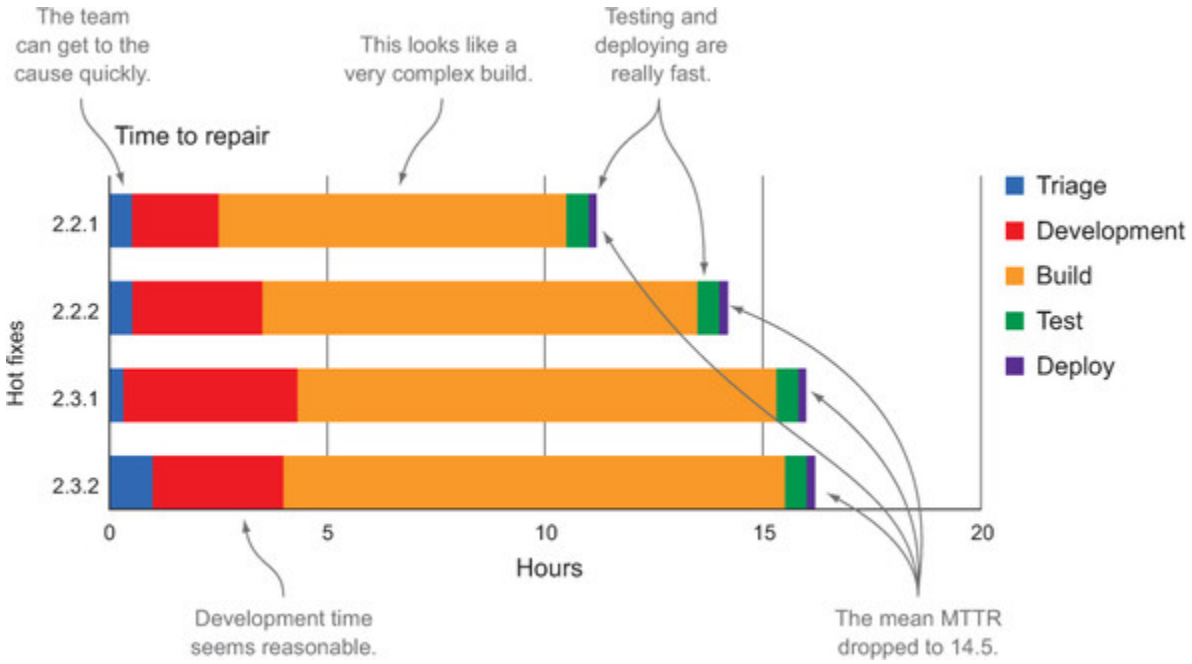


In figure 8.7 the team can get to the root of problems and update the code quickly, indicating the codebase is much more maintainable than that shown in figure 8.6. But the build takes a really long time, so reducing build time is an actionable item the team can take away from these measurements. In this case it may also be a good idea to cross-reference the shorter test cycle with metrics to ensure that your team has adequate test coverage and they're not just skipping tests for the sake of speed.

For the teams on the ground adding features and fixing problems, you can break into even finer details like how much code has to change in these time ranges and what's taking time inside the build process. For this detail you need to add more data.

8.3.2. Adding SCM and build data

What gets built and how often is the next key indicator of a maintainable codebase. Commits with a high CLOC (changed lines of code) are a sign that it takes a lot of work to change things. If you start to break down the elements of a change to your software products, the number of lines of code it takes to fix things or deliver new features is one of the primary indicators of maintainability. *A good target to have is a low CLOC, a high number of*